

“Ubuntu grew 160 per cent in India last year”

Canonical is bullish on its Indian operations and the company has every reason to feel so. Not only is its operating system, Ubuntu, making serious inroads into the Indian market, the company is also getting many OEMs to ship their laptops with Ubuntu pre-loaded. Recently, Canonical kicked off its second biggest retail expansion programme in India in collaboration with Dell, where the latter will be selling Ubuntu pre-loaded laptops in 850 retail stores across the country. Early next year, Canonical plans to launch Ubuntu TV as well. All this, and much more, brought **Canonical's CEO Jane Silber** to the country to explore the current expansion options. **Diksha P Gupta** from **LINUX For You** caught up with Silber to discuss everything to do with Ubuntu and Canonical. And did they talk of its recent friendship with Microsoft? Read on...

India is a prime playground for Canonical...

Q What is your tie-up with Dell all about?

A We have announced a new initiative in India in partnership with Dell, where there will be 850 Dell retail stores promoting Ubuntu in a retail environment. It's a really important signal. It's bringing open source and Linux out from the world of tech enthusiasts and open source advocates into the mainstream. People in those stores will be trained on Ubuntu, so that they can pass that knowledge on to anybody who comes into the store and help make them an informed choice on whether they want Ubuntu or any other operating system. It's similar to a programme we have done in China as well, and that programme has been running for about a year with very good results. So we are very excited to be able to do that in India. We see a lot of growth and potential in India. We will be meeting with partners, government users and folks like that.

Jane Silber, CEO, Canonical

